

## UNIT 2 / Numbers and identity

# Numbers from zero to twenty

Your goal: Use small numbers for ages, quantities and contact details.

## 01 Learn the idea

Learn null, eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf, sechs, sieben, acht, neun and zehn first. Eleven and twelve are elf and zwölf. From thirteen, many numbers combine a small number with zehn: dreizehn, vierzehn and fünfzehn. Sixteen and seventeen shorten to sechzehn and siebzehn.

Use Wie viele? for a count of things and Wie alt? for age. In German, age uses sein: Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt, literally I am twenty years old. When giving a telephone number, speaking one digit at a time is clear and practical. Say zero as null, not the letter O.

## Words and phrases

| German           | English          |
|------------------|------------------|
| null             | zero             |
| zwölf            | twelve           |
| sechzehn         | sixteen          |
| zwanzig          | twenty           |
| Wie alt bist du? | How old are you? |

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

## 02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

**Mia**

Wie alt bist du?

How old are you?

**Ben**

Ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt. Und du?

I am twenty years old. And you?

**Mia**

Ich bin neunzehn.

I am nineteen.

### Your real-life mission

Count from zero to twenty. Write five imaginary telephone digits and read them aloud individually. Give the ages of two fictional people.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

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## 03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

### 1. What does “null” mean?

- A. twelve
- B. sixteen
- C. zero

### 2. What does “zwölf” mean?

- A. twelve
- B. sixteen
- C. twenty

### 3. What does “sechzehn” mean?

- A. twenty
- B. sixteen
- C. How old are you?

### 4. Which spelling means sixteen?

- A. sechszehn
- B. sechzehn
- C. sechzig

### 5. How old is Mia?

- A. Twenty
- B. Twelve
- C. Nineteen

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

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# 04 Answer key and review

## 1. C - zero

“null” means “zero”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

## 2. A - twelve

“zwölf” means “twelve”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

## 3. B - sixteen

“sechzehn” means “sixteen”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

## 4. B - sechzehn

Sechzehn drops the s from sechs. Sechzig means sixty.

## 5. C - Nineteen

Mia says Ich bin neunzehn.

## One possible mission response

Null, fünf, acht, zwei, neun. Ben ist zwanzig Jahre alt. Mia ist neunzehn.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

## Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

## Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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